responsibility. Sometime in late January 1985, Jindal was at Cafe Aida in Landstrasse, Vienna. He had waited for almost a week for this meeting with his old informer Sophie Klor. Jindal, known by a different name at the time, had dumped her two years earlier at the end of an operation he had run in Austria.

It is not unusual for an intelligence officer to dump her or his source or informer once the job is done. There are no permanent relationships in the world of espionage. Everyone has an expiry date. But Sophie was perhaps an exception. A history graduate, she worked with a non-governmental organisation based in Vienna. Jindal had met her at a human rights conference and was professionally drawn to her fierce condemnation of Pakistan's activities and American interference in South Asia, specifically Afghanistan. She came to admire Jindal's political and military knowledge of Europe and his strong views on the cold war. Their mutual respect helped Jindal earn her trust and he was able to recruit her as what the R&AW called a subconscious agent, meaning an agent activated not against her or his own country but a third country. Sophie assisted Jindal in his Austria operation. Like the R&AW's other subconscious agents in Europe in the 1980s and 1990s, she transferred money to moles, trained new assets in the target country and occasionally ran assets on behalf of the handler.

'So your socialist leader has got the Jawaharlal Nehru Award/ Jindal teased Sophie as soon as she pulled out a chair to sit down.

'You cannot discount Bruno's contribution to Austria. At least, he was firm and fought for equality like your great leader,' Sophie said curtly, referring to Dr Bruno Kreisky, who had been Austria's chancellor for almost thirteen